IBM cc A. Kolsky 413

Date: March 26, 1959
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Subject and/or Reference: STRETCH Contract Revision

We are happy to see that instead of just dropping two banks of half micro second memory, that they are being replaced by two banks of two micro second memory. Los Alamos is assuming, and very strongly so, that they are going to get six banks of memory. It has been shown that the half micro second memory is not the important factor in speed. If on the other hand we furnish just four banks of memory we loose the conflict free flow of data and instructions which tends to make up the speed we have lost in our instruction times, which is considerable.

The machine outlined in the revision is a very good adjustment of components and speed.

Loss to Los Alamos	Gains for Los Alamos
Slower Arithmetic Speeds	Extra 64 524 Words of Memory
.5 Mic Memory	Extra Disk Storage
Input/Output Computer	

With these offsetting gains and losses, we should have no problems with Los Alamos on the contract revisions. No problems are anticipated due to the loss of the input/output computer since it has been mutually agreed that the approach we made is much better. The "number" of memory banks rather than amount of memory has always been a strong point with Los Alamos, so it should be a small problem selling them the replacement of half mic memory by two mic memory. Any offer less than six would surely bring up a strong argument.

We would like to stress the importance of delivery on time. We are on very good terms with Los Alamos and have been for many years and do not want to see another "Lark" situation here at Los Alamos. A late delivery to Los Alamos would blacken our name from coast to coast as well as here, since every one is watching the development of STRETCH.

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